

Borel Ahonon

ASSISTANT PROFESSOR OF FINANCE · UNIVERSITÉ LAVAL

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2026 – **Assistant Professor of Finance**, Université Laval, Canada

EDUCATION

2020–2026 Ph.D. in Finance, **McGill University**, Canada
2017–2019 Master of Research in Management, **IESE Business School**, Spain
2016–2017 M.Sc. in Corporate Finance, *part-time*, **Emlyon Business School**, France
2009–2012 M.Sc. in Statistics and Economics, **ENSEA**, Côte d'Ivoire
2005–2008 B.Sc. in Statistics, **ENEAM**, Benin

REFERENCES

Prof. Patrick Augustin
Desautels Faculty of Management
McGill University
patrick.augustin@mcgill.ca

Prof. Guillaume Roussellet
Desautels Faculty of Management
McGill University
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Prof. Daniel Andrei
SFI Senior Chair, Professor of Finance
HEC Lausanne, University of Lausanne
daniel.andrei@unil.ch

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Asset Pricing, Macrofinance, International Finance, Sovereign Credit Risk, Term Structure of Interest Rates, and Financial Econometrics.

WORKING PAPERS

When Long-Run Trends Are Unknown: Bond Pricing Implications [[SSRN](#)] [[New York Fed](#)]

with Guillaume Roussellet

We propose a macro-finance model in which inflation, growth, and the policy rate are driven by unobservable long-run trends and transitory cycles that investors must infer from aggregate data. Their subjective estimates of these trends, and the uncertainty surrounding them, are priced into the Treasury yield curve in a tractable way through both interest rate expectations and bond risk premia. Empirical estimates reveal an upward smooth trend in the long-run real interest rate (r^*) until the 1980s, and large investor uncertainty with confidence bands as wide as 3.4 percentage points, contrasting with the volatile rate implied by perfect information models.

Presented at: International Association for Applied Econometrics (2026), North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society (2026), Quantitative Finance and Financial Econometrics (2026), Queen's University (2026), University of Luxembourg (2025), Federal Reserve Bank of New York (2024), Société Canadienne de Sciences Économiques (2024), Fixed Income Markets and Inflation Conference (2024), McGill University (2024)

Sovereign Credit Risk and the Tale of Two Inflations [[Link](#)]

I examine the effects of domestic and U.S. inflation on sovereign credit risk. Using monthly data for twenty-three advanced economies between 2001 and 2022, I document that domestic inflation raises sovereign CDS spreads, whereas U.S. inflation lowers them. These opposite effects operate mainly through investors' expectations of sovereign default rather than risk premia. The negative association between U.S. inflation and sovereign credit risk reflects a “good inflation” channel, where

price increases arise during periods of stronger economic activity and lower default probabilities. In contrast, domestic inflation signals tighter monetary policy and weaker fiscal prospects, heightening concerns about debt sustainability.

Presented at: Université Laval (2026), McGill University (2025), 12th Montreal Business School Joint-PhD Symposium (2025)

A Macrofinance Perspective on the Twin Ds – Default and Depreciation Risks [\[Link\]](#)

How are sovereign credit risk and exchange rate related? How does the difference in credit default swaps (CDS) spreads on the same entity but denominated in different currencies, i.e. quanto spread, arise? I empirically document a negative contemporaneous relationship between sovereign credit risk and exchange rate and a positive predictability of exchange rates by quanto CDS spreads. I then propose an international macrofinance model in which the level, volatility, and term structure of quanto spread are driven by a rare disaster risk with time-varying probability and its contagion effect. These features of quanto spread depend on the correlation of cross-country expected consumption volatilities and present a trade-off: an upward term structure of quanto spread and a strong negative contemporaneous relationship lead to a negative predictability relationship and exceedingly high exchange rate volatility.

Presented/Accepted at: Southern Finance Association (2025), Northern Finance Association (poster, 2025), EFMA Doctoral Seminar (2025), Canadian Economics Association (2025), Global Finance Conference (2025), 19th CIREQ PhD Students' Conference (2025), McGill University (2022)

DISCUSSION

2025	The Benefit of Inflation-Indexed Debt: Evidence from an Emerging Bond Market, by Cristhian Cardozo and Jens Christensen, Southern Finance Association Annual Meetings
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TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Fall 2026	Portfolio Management (French section – BCom), Instructor, Université Laval
Summer 2025	Introduction to Finance , Instructor, McGill University
Winter 2025	The Firm in the Macroeconomy – MCGR 294 , Teaching Assistant, McGill University
Fall 2022	Advanced Finance Seminar – FINE 547 , Teaching Assistant, McGill University

WORK EXPERIENCE

2020/06–2020/09	Research Assistant , Université Laval, Canada
2013/06–2017/06	Strategy and Research Analyst , MDE Business School, Côte d'Ivoire
2012/09–2013/04	Business Intelligence Analyst , Comium, Côte d'Ivoire
2011/08–2011/12	Research Analyst , Ministry of Economy and Finance, Benin
2009/01–2009/09	Research Analyst in the Macroeconomic Unit , Ministry of Economy and Finance, Benin

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS

2025–2026	PhD Arbour Scholarship (30,000 CAD) , Arbour Foundation
2025–2026	CSIRF PhD Scholarship Award (25,000 CAD) , Canadian Securities Institute Research Foundation
2024–2025	PS752 Commemorative Scholarship (29,000 CAD) , Foreign Affairs, Trade and Development Canada
2023–2025	FRQ Doctoral Scholarship (58,333 CAD) , Fonds de Recherche du Québec, Société et Culture
2023	FTG Summer School Fellowship (500 USD) , Finance Theory Group and the JFQA
2022–2023	Canadian Derivatives Exchange Graduate Scholarship (25,000 CAD) , Montreal Exchange, Inc.
2020–2025	Graduate Excellence Award in Management , McGill University
2020–2021	Richard Evans Entry Fellowship (15,000 CAD) , Rio Tinto Limited
2020–2021	Rathlyn Fellowship in Management (10,000 CAD) , Rathlyn Foundation
2017–2019	IESE MRM Scholarship , IESE International Foundation

2009–2012	Odon Vallet Scholarship , Vallet Foundation
2009–2012	National Scholarship for Study Abroad , Government of Benin
2008	ITU Telecom Africa 2008 Youth Fellowship , International Telecommunication Union
2005–2008	National Scholarship , Government of Benin

COMMUNITY AND SOCIAL LEADERSHIP

2025/09 –	Governing Board Member , École Judith-Jasmin, CSSDM, Montreal, Canada
2023/09–2025/08	Chairperson of the Governing Board , École Notre-Dame-des-Neiges, CSSDM, Montreal, Canada
2022/09–2025/08	Governing Board Member , École Notre-Dame-des-Neiges, CSSDM, Montreal, Canada
2021/12 –	Member , Quebec PhD Workshops in Economics, Statistics, and Finance, Canada
2016/01–2017/05	Project Coordinator , Yaouré Cultural Center, Yamoussoukro, Côte d'Ivoire
2012/01–2017/05	Student Empowerment & Community Development Leader , Comoé Cultural Center, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire
2011/12–2012/06	Election Coordinator , ENSEA Student Association, Abidjan, Côte d'Ivoire
2007/09–2008/09	General Secretary , Benin Association of Statistics Students, Benin

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Programming	R, Python, MATLAB, STATA, SPSS
Languages	English (Fluent), French (Native), Spanish (Intermediate), Fon (Native), Gun (Native)
Citizenship	Benin (Citizen), Canada (Permanent Resident)

AUGUST 2026